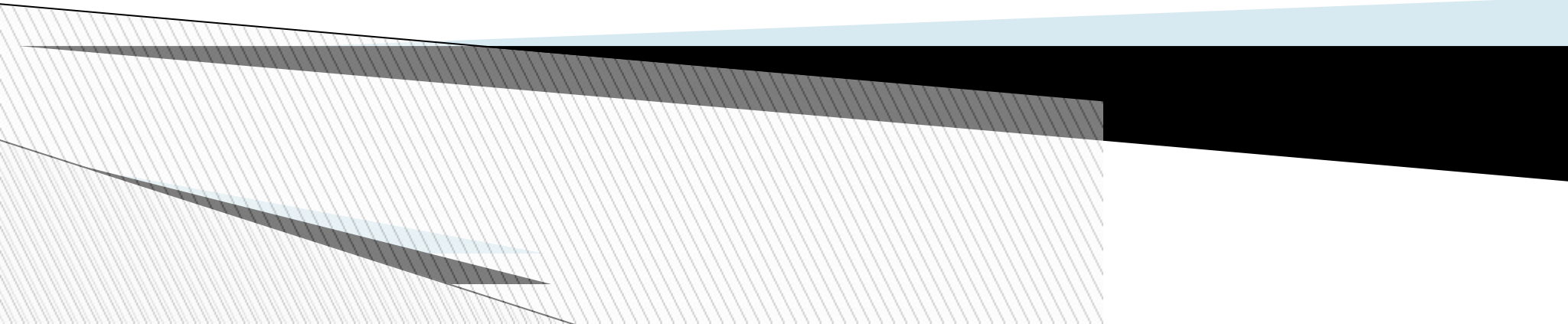


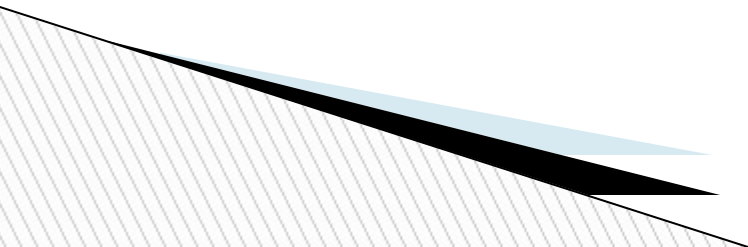
Phishing Awareness Training

Strengthening the Human Firewall in 2026
Project by: Muhammad Talha | CodeAlpha Intern



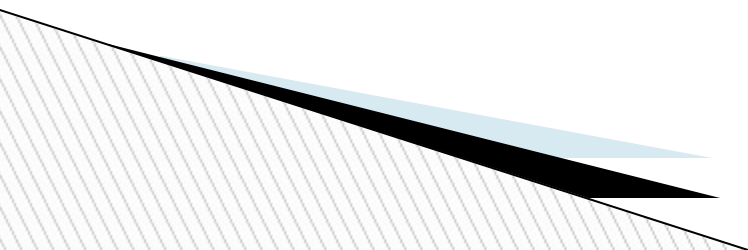
1. Understanding Phishing

The silent threat that enters through your inbox.

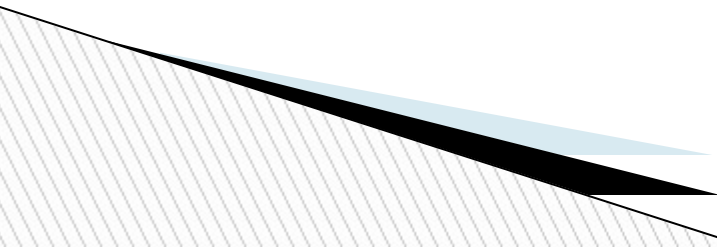


The Global Impact

- 91% of successful cyber breaches start with a phishing email.
- Attackers don't 'hack' in; they 'log' in by tricking employees.
- Bypasses millions of dollars of hardware security tools.
- Business Email Compromise (BEC) causes billions in losses globally.

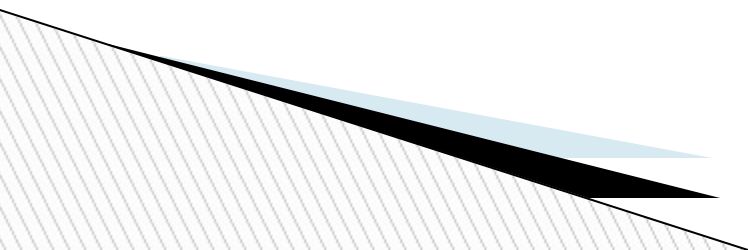


Most Impersonated Platforms

- Microsoft / Office 365 (28%): Fake password expiry & shared doc links.
 - Google Workspace (14%): Malicious shared drive files & security alerts.
 - LinkedIn (13%): Fake connection requests & job offer updates.
 - Other Brands (45%): Shipping notifications, banking alerts, etc.
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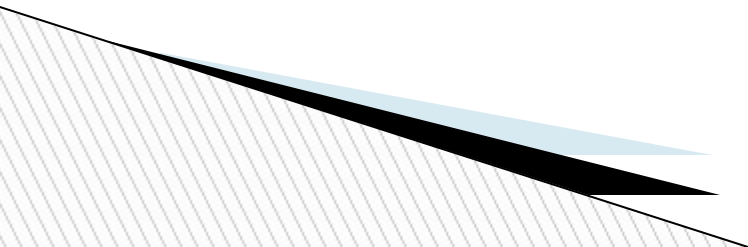
AI-Phishing Growth Trend

- Perfect Professional Grammar: AI models eliminate spelling & structural errors.
- Automated email filters and standard eye-checks are becoming less effective.
- Scalable Personalization: Attackers scrape public social profiles for targeted content.
- Bad actors can now launch sophisticated, customized templates at a massive scale.



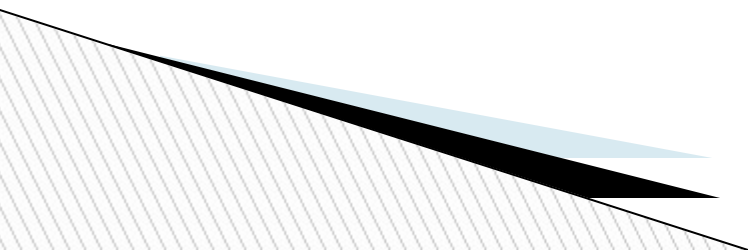
2. Spotting the Red Flags

Becoming an expert at identifying active deception



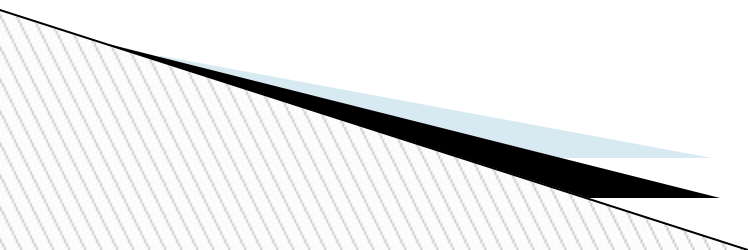
The Anatomy of a Fake

- • Artificial Urgency: Messages demanding immediate action to induce panic.
- • Strange Sender Address Domains: Look closely for replacements like [@micros0ft-verify.com](#)
- • Hidden Hyperlink Destinations: Real URL destination on mouse hover doesn't match company.

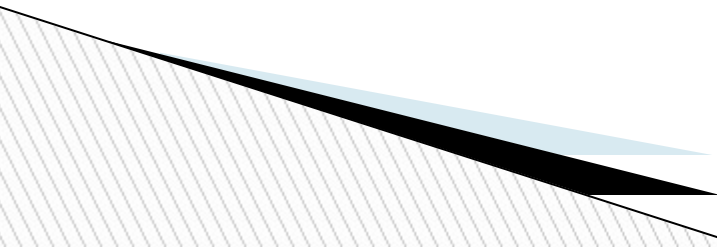


Common Psychological Tactics

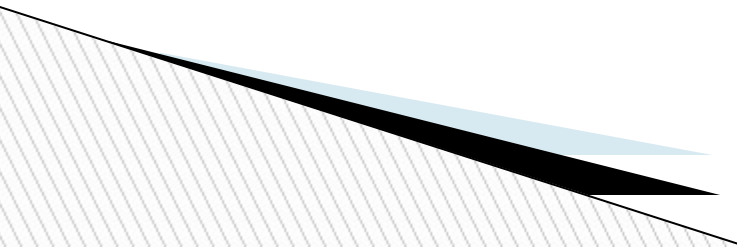
- • Urgency: Making you act fast without thinking logically or verifying.
- • Authority: Pretending to be executive leadership, HR, or law enforcement.
- • Curiosity: Luring targets with attachments like 'Q3 Salary review sheet' or 'Bonus details'.



Phishing Variants to Know

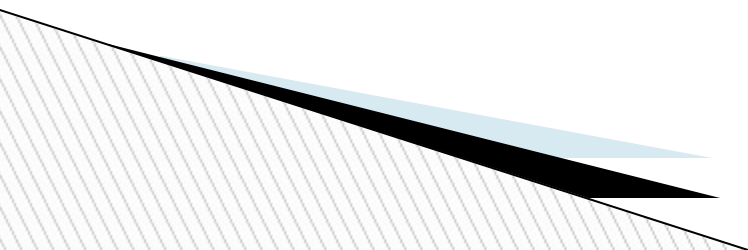
- • Smishing (SMS / Text): Urgent package delivery updates or banking security tokens.
 - • Vishing (Voice Call): Using deepfakes or caller ID spoofing to impersonate internal staff.
 - • Quishing (QR Codes): Scanned QR codes that bypass email filters to open credential links.
 - • Spear Phishing (Targeted Email): Highly researched individual attacks using personal info.
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Incident Response Protocol

- 1. STOP: Do not click hyperlinks, download attachments, or reply.
 - 2. VERIFY: Reach out to the sender via an established internal phone call or chat.
 - 3. REPORT: Forward the threat to the designated information security inbox.
 - 4. DELETE: Permanently remove the email once officially cleared or flagged.
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Best Practices for 2026

- • Enforce Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) as your primary line of defense.
- • Deploy a Dedicated Password Manager to avoid dangerous password reuse.
- • Maintain Healthy Skepticism: Investigate irregular or unprompted financial requests.



Think Before You Click.

SECURITY IS A SHARED RESPONSIBILITY
MUHAMMAD TALHA | CODEALPHA INTERN

